



Saving Money on Printing

- Use draft print mode if the printout is not meant as the final copy.
- Use a smaller font if the printout is meant only for checks.
- Leave the printer on because each time it is switched on or off, the printer purges ink to clean the print head.
- Opt for a printer that has individual ink tanks. That would save you the cost of having to replace an entire ink cartridge just because one or two colours have run out.
- Reduce paper consumption through duplex printing, which involves printing on both sides of the paper. However, this feature is not available in all printers. Some printers have printer drivers that can print multiple pages on a sheet. Multi-up printing is an excellent way to save paper as it reduces paper and ink use, speeds up the printing process and causes less wear and tear on printers.
- You can also use software such as FinePrint 2000 to print two, four, or even eight pages on a single piece of paper. It will also allow you to print on both sides of the paper even if your printer does not support dual-sided printing. A trial version of the software is available for download at www.fineprint.com.

black cartridge and Rs 1,390 for colour, so the cost per page works out to Rs 3.45.

On the other hand, we have the inexpensive Lexmark Z13, with a price tag of just Rs 2,990, but which serves up an exorbitant cost per page of Rs 8.80. Add up the price of its black cartridge and colour cartridge (a total of Rs 2,400) and you might as well buy a new printer. But nothing can beat the Olivetti Artjet 12 for its sky high cost per page. It runs up to Rs 11.50 per page and this is primarily because its cartridges cost an astronomical Rs 2,236 (black) and Rs 2,412 (colour). If you add up these prices, it amounts to buying another Artjet 12!

The cost per page is higher for mid-range printers because their cartridges cost more. The worst of the lot was the Lexmark Z45. The cartridge cost is really high (Rs 1,695 for black and Rs 1,995 for colour) and the printing volumes for black and colour are quite low. As a result, the Lexmark has a per page printing cost of Rs 12. The Olivetti isn't too far behind either, with a cost per page of Rs 11.30.

The HP trio—the 845C, 920C and the 948C—achieved a cost per page of around Rs 5.50. The cartridge cost of all HP printers doesn't exceed Rs 1,700 for the colour and Rs 1,400 for black cartridge. Couple this with the high page counts per cartridge and you have the right balance.

The best of the lot here though was the Canon S300. It printed 119 black pages and 153 colour pages. Factor in the low priced cartridges (Rs 395 for black and Rs 695 for colour) and you get an amazing low cost of Rs 3.78 per page.

Epson's strategy in the high-end bracket is probably the perfect strategy to adopt. It has kept cartridge costs at just around Rs 1,000 with relatively decent page counts. Take for example the Epson Stylus 895, which printed 257 black and 183 colour pages. Its cartridge costs a really low Rs 820 for colour and Rs 790 for black. This translates to a low cost per page of Rs 3.60.

But the champion here is without doubt the HP Deskjet 970CXi. It prints a voluminous 455 pages for the black cartridge and its cartridges are priced fairly reasonably at Rs 1,670 for colour and Rs 1,350 for black. It achieves a very economical Rs 4.70 per page.

The Canon S4500 too can print large volumes (228 pages for

1/2 page V. AD